Microsoft. Along with other open source projects that comprise ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET Web API, ASP.NET Web Pages, Windows Azure SDK and ADO.NET Entity Framework, Microsoft is believed to have licensed the new project under the Apache 2.0 licence.

A new energy management controller based on Linux

Canada-based 'Check-It Solutions' has created a Linux-based appliance to control and monitor the automation and energy management of residential and commercial buildings. The appliance, which is called CG-300 Controller, is powered by a 1.2GHz Marvell Armada 300.

The device offers Ethernet, ZigBee, Z-Wave and optional LTE. It is available for sale as part of the Energy Management Starter Kit, which includes smartphone accessible Web-portal services, Energy Star benchmarking and a Dent metering device.

The CG-300 has been created to recover data from different locations. According to Check-It Solutions, "It can operate as a standalone controller in commercial or residential buildings, or it can communicate with existing building automation systems via protocols, including BACnet or Modbus, to centralise monitoring information or control functions."

The device comes with 512 MB of DDR3 RAM, 1 GB of SLC NAND flash, a gigabit Ethernet port, and dual USB ports. The device's internal SLC NAND flash provides 'high write endurance'. A CG-300c model also offers a 4G LTE/HSPA radio.

An Android app for the paralysed

It's the 21st century and there is an app for everything—from managing your TV to getting your car fixed. The latest to join the line is an app that has been developed by a student of the Indian Institute of Technology, Gandhinagar (IIT-Gn) and is aimed at doing a bit of social good.

The app is for Android users and provides people paralysed below the neck with greater freedom of movement. Pritesh Sankhe, a final year electrical engineering student, is the developer of the app. In making the app, he says, he has tried to fuse the technology of robotics and the simplicity of mobile phones on the Android operating system. Although the application is still in the development stage, according to Sankhe, there is a possibility that it will soon be developed and workable for those confined to a wheelchair.

"Smartphones are everywhere nowadays and people are using them innovatively. Efforts have been made to improve human-robot interaction but, at the moment, the best example of this is maybe an on-board computer for paralysed people. How about shrinking the computer to the size of a smartphone and employing it for day-to-day tasks?" said Sankhe.

Sankhe says that he worked closely under the tutelage of Prof Uttama Lahiri, who is also his guide. He started work on the framework of the app, bearing in mind the fact that its users wouldn't be able to move their limbs but would, in all likelihood, be able to control the app through slight movements of the head and the neck. "We placed a bright-coloured object on the user's forehead that can be easily identified by the smartphone camera. Then, we wrote a software that would track the blob's movements and replicate it to command the wheelchair," Sankhe said.

Convert Android apps into Glass apps with GlassBridge

Have you been following the progress of Glass apps but feel they still lag behind in the apps field? As we all know, while Glass is an Android device, it is not designed to run Android apps the way they run on an Android smartphone. But did you know that Glass users can still enjoy the goodness of Android apps on Glass, without compromising too much on its quality? Here's introducing GlassBridge, which, in simple terms, converts your Android apps into Glass apps. It takes native Android apps and Bookmarks, and allows you to place them in the Timeline UI, working pretty much like Glass.

With the continuing growth of the Glass Explorer program, users are fast exploring new ways to use the Glass hardware. With apps like GlassBridge, many questions that were left unanswered by Google are now being solved. Google had announced, right in the beginning, that it would be releasing the API, which could be used by developers to deliver interesting apps.

Glass is still very limited and has nothing even remotely similar in the market. According to a Geek report, the recent update offered a Glass-friendly browser, with the ability to look at most websites, but the lack of a proper bookmarking system or the ability to log in to anything, left the experience somewhat incomplete, until now.

Coming to the flip side, GlassBridge is pretty vulnerable at this stage, but that does not undermine its scope for exploring various possibilities. Primarily, users are making use of the Android Debug Bridge to load an app, which then syncs with a Glassware app, thereby allowing a more Glass-friendly set of controls at the time of launching apps and bookmarks.